

MB 538: Management Insights from Indian Knowledge Systems

Course Code: MB 538

Course Name: Management Insights from Indian Knowledge Systems

L-T-P-C: 2-0-0-2

Prerequisites: NA

Intended for: MBA DS&AI and IMBA

Mutual Exclusion: No similar course is offered in the institute.

Approval: 59th BoA (I-MBA curriculum; as MB 581 in the MBA table); recoded from MB 581 to MB 538 and course proposal approved in the 60th BoA

Preamble

The course aims to impart the students with the timeless life-lessons and management insights from the Indian knowledge system contained in scriptural texts such as Bhagavad Gita, Ramayana, and Mahabharata. These scriptures enunciate significant principles of moral/ethical management in individual, organizational and societal levels. The concepts such as Dharma (including swadharma, parodharma, apat dharma), Karma (Sakarma, Vikarma, Akarma, Niskama Karma, Karma Yoga) from Bhagavad Gita are pivotal in guiding the actions of a manager in right direction to bring in personal satisfaction, professional excellence and social wellbeing. Ramayana and Mahabharata offer live demonstrations of ethical and efficient management principles through the actions of pivot characters such as Lord Ram, Lord Krishna, Arjuna, Hanuman etc. Insights from these scriptures will equip the MBA DS&AI students and IMBA students with the wisdom to excel as ethical and efficient managers and leaders.

Course Modules

- **Unit 1: Management Insights from Bhagavad Gita:** (14 hours)
 - Dealing with Dilemmas of life (Chapter 1 of Bhagavad Gita)
 - Deciphering the problem of Identity (Chapter 2 of Bhagavad Gita)
 - Dharma and Karma: Principles governing our Action and focusing on excellence: lessons from Karma Yoga (Chapter 3 and 5 of Bhagavad Gita)
 - Understanding the human mind and art of controlling the mind: Lessons from Dhyana Yoga (Chapter 6 of Bhagavad Gita)
 - Understanding the Psycho-physical constitution, developing qualities to be a good leader/manager, building leadership character, learning to assign right people in right job (Chapter 7, 14 and 17 of Bhagavad Gita)
 - Transformational managerial principles (Chapter 9, 16 and 18 of Bhagavad Gita)
- **Unit 2: Leadership Insights from Ramayan:** (8 Hours)
 - Principles of moral management in top of the hierarchy: Insights from the life of king Dasharath
 - Increasing happiness quotient through detachment (Inspiration from Lord Rama's action while being exiled)
 - Enhancing Emotional quotient and intricacies of relationship (Inspiration from relationship among Ram, Laxman, Bharat, Satrugna, Sita, Hanuman)

- Character of a situational manager: Powerful yet humble, peaceful yet brave fighter (The life of Hanuman in Sundarkand)
- A manager who inspires the followers to realize their potential (The life of Jambavan)
- Overcoming challenges with exemplary qualities and character (Hanuman's Journey to Lanka)
- Dharma above everything else (Actions of Lord Ram)

• **Unit 3: Leadership Insights from Mahabharat:** (6 Hours)

- Sacrifice as a way of life (Lessons from the life of Kunti Maharani)
- Justice and fairness: Fearless manager (Lessons from the life of Vidura/Vidura Niti)
- Motivated blindness and the consequences (Lessons from the life of Dhritarashtra)
- Principle vs Rules (Lessons from the Activities of Lord Krishna)
- The double-edged sword of Dharma (Lessons from life of Karna)
- Endeavour and Mercy: The formula for success (The life of Pandavas)
- Service vs Enjoyment (Lessons from Pandavas and Kauravas)

Text Books

1. Prabhupada, ACBS, *Bhagavad Gita as it is*, Bhakti Vedanta Book Trust, India, 1973.
2. Vilas, Shubha, *OPEN EYED MEDITATIONS*, Finger Print Publications, India, 2016.
3. Vyasa, Krishna Dwipayana, *Vidura Niti*, Gorakhpur Geeta Press. 2025.

References

1. Vilas, Shubha, *Ramayana: The game of life* (Book1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6), Jaico Publishing House, India, 2017, 2029, & 2021.
2. Dharma, Krishna, *Ramayana*, Mandala Publishing, India, 2020.
3. Dharma, Krishna, *Mahabharata: The Greatest Spiritual Epic of All Time*, Mandala Publishing, India, 2020.
4. Valmiki, *Shrimad Valmikiya Ramayan* (Part 1 & 2), India, GITA PRESS GORAKHPUR, 2022.
5. Ganguli, K. M. *The Complete Mahabharata in English*. India. 2017.